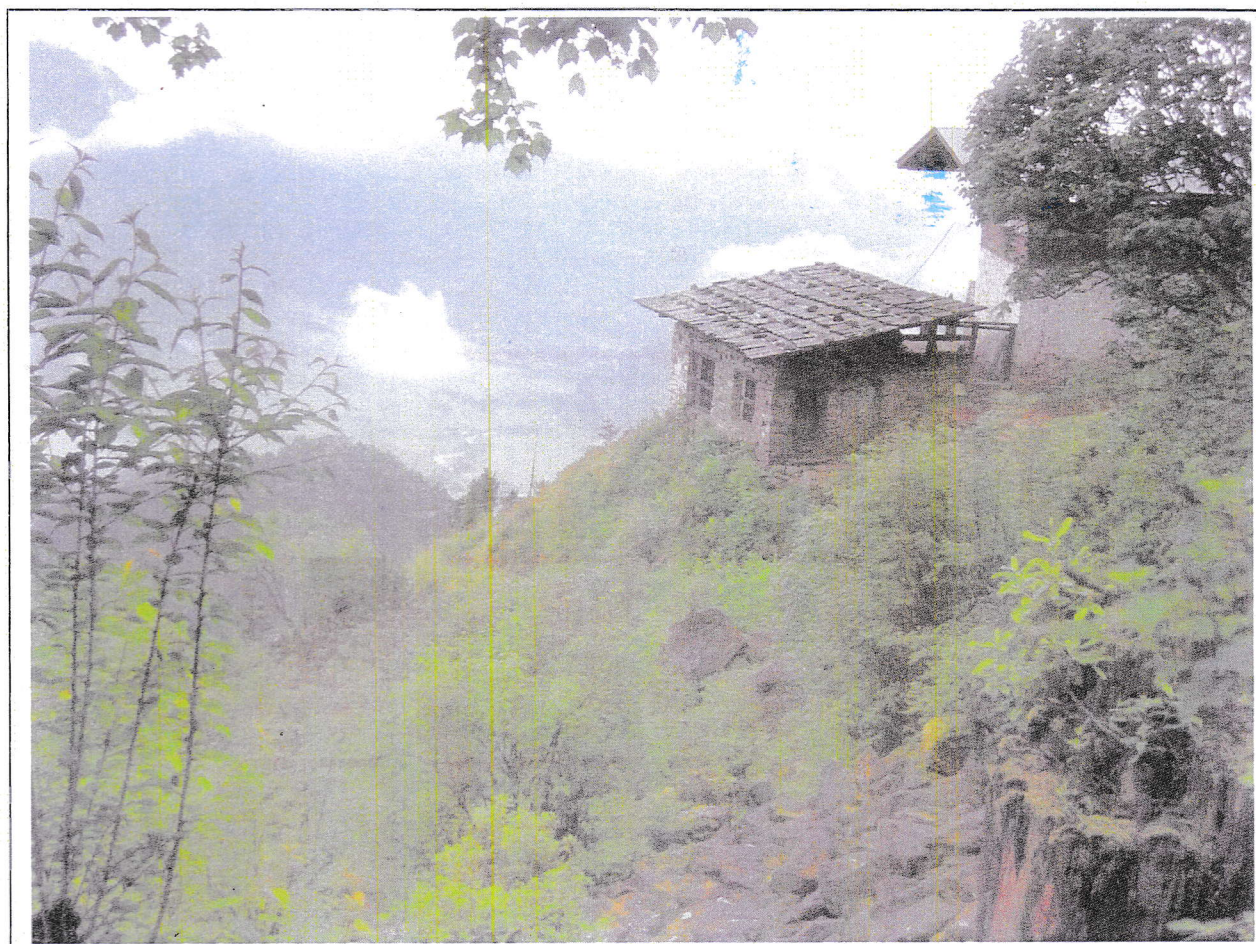


Gorgoen Shingmin Thoenketh
Management Group



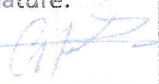
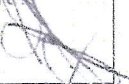
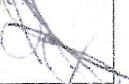
**Gogona, Gangtey Geog,
Wangdue Phodrang**

Plan Period: Jan 2020 – Dec 2022

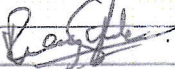
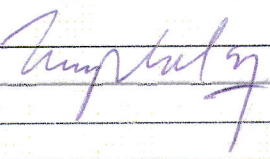
APPROVAL SHEET

Name of NWFP Management and Marketing Group:	Gorgoen Shingmin Thoenked Management Group
Dzongkhag:	Wangdue
Gewog:	Gangtey
Village(s):	Eubja, Chubja, Thankha, Gogochungsho, Gogona, Zasar, Gogojevkh
No. of households:	40
Area (in ha.)	
Plan Period:	Jan 2020 – Dec 2022

Prepared and submitted for approval

NWFP Management and Marketing Group	Forestry Representative (Facilitator)	Gewog Administration	Social Forestry Section Head	Head of the Division/Park
Signature: 	Signature: 	Signature: 	Signature: 	Signature: 
Name: Kumbu Dorji	Name: Tashi Wangchuk	Name: Gyeltshen	Name: Karma Tenzin	Name: Karma Tenzin
Title: Chairperson	Title: FMU Incharge	Title: Gup	Title:	Title: Chief Forestry Officer
Date:	Date:	Date:	Date:	Date:

REVIEWED AND RECOMMENDED FOR APPROVAL

Signature: 	Signature: 
Name: Rinzin Wangchuk	Name:
Position Title: Sr. Forestry Officer	Position Title:

APPROVED BY


DIRECTOR

DEPARTMENT OF FOREST AND PARK SERVICES

Part I: Collection and Management guideline

Background

Gorgoen Shingmin Thoenketh Management Group under Gogona Chiwog, Gangtey Geog, Wangdue Dzongkhag is located in the south west part of the Geog. The Chiwog shares its boundary with Bjena Geog in the west and Athang Geog in the south. The Chiwog has 42 households with the total population of 200 plus people approximately. Almost all the people from Gogona community totally depend on potato farming and cattle as their main source of income, followed by collection of NWFP such as plants for incense making. For more than a century people of Gogona have been collecting the Non-Wood Forest Produce (NWFP) mainly for the domestic use and some even for commercial purpose. However, with the growing numbers of people collecting and hunting for NWFP including Paris, the pressure has increased over the recent years. Therefore, in order to reduce such pressure and also to manage in a sustainable way, community of Gogona decided to form a user group so that the protection is ensured through the management of the area by the group.

The people of Gogona totally depend on biodiversity resources from the FMU, such as timber, firewood, fodder, pasture and NWFP. In olden days people from neighboring communities besides the residents usually collect some medicinal plants and incense for their local use as well as to barter with the rice when they travel to Wangdue and Punakha regions. The importance of NWFP for income generation was recognized long time ago; however there has been no proper management system and guidelines followed by these people. It is therefore important to understand and appreciate the crucial role NWFPs play in supporting rural livelihoods. Further, increasing economic value of NWFPs and expanding markets have created added opportunities in terms on generating household income, and challenges to local level NWFP management in terms of sustainable management. Such new challenges and opportunities need to be taken into account to foster sustainable and utilization of NWFP by the local people.

In the recent years, it has been observed that outsider come to collect NWFPs such as *Paris* and other mushrooms which are thought to have high value in the black market fetching fair prices. In neighboring communities, such groups have already come up to fend their area of

collection through formation of management groups with the help of the DoFPS. Gogona has been a host to a rich variety of plants which are associated with the medicinal values and use besides the use in the traditional rituals. So the community people have been desperate to fend the outsiders from coming in to collect the NWFP resources illegally. With this, few of the community members deemed understanding got their doubts cleared through the policy and regulations of the DoFPS which was carried out over a few hours casual talk. After understanding the rules and guidelines, people of Gogona showed their interest to form NWFP user group whereby this first management plan is partial result of that move. The current NWFP management plan of Gorgoen Shingmin Thoenketh Management Group will be for the period of three years commencing from 2019-2024. The plan consists of two parts, viz: the Resources Management and BY-LAWS parts respectively. The Resources Management part will emphasize on how user group will manage and utilize the resources on sustainable basis with equity and justice, where the By-Laws will guide and enforce the terms agreed by the NWFP group.

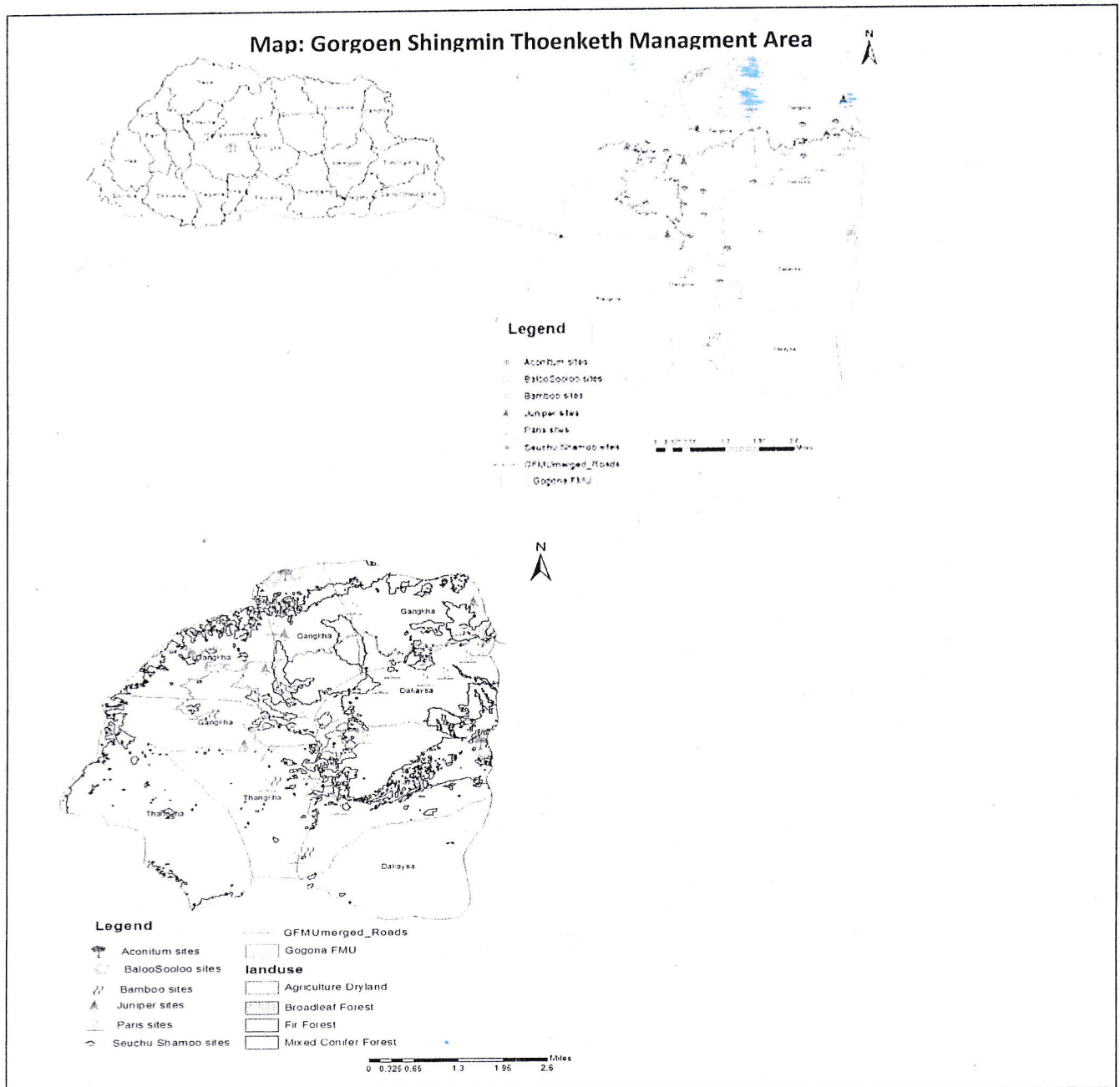
Management Objectives:

Objectives of management are mainly to:

- Protect from illegal harvesting of NWFP products by outsiders
- To generate income and enhance the livelihood of the community
- Manage and use NWFP resources in the area designated (in the NWFP plan) in a sustainable manner.

General information on NWFP collection site

The collection of NWFP will be mainly carried out from the various sites within the FMU boundary. This is based on the availability of resources (as per resource map) and the past collection accounts. The names of collection site are as follow:



Proper collection season

The NWFP collection has to follow the right season and timing because the plants and incense, if collected on right time, toxicity content, quality and effectiveness of the intended use of individual plants is much higher. Therefore, right timing is important and is must for the quality of the raw materials as well as for sustainable management. The collection site shall be clean, pleasant and fertile places endowed with the balance of sunshine, wind and rainfall. The group have decided not to collect NWFP from the unsuitable area such as waste disposal area, fire affected area and also from the local dwelling places of local deities. This is with reference to the view of experts of the traditional medicine. And the NWFP looks forward to have NITM as potential customer in the future thereby making sure their criteria of collection is followed.

Table 1: Brief description and prescription of NWFPs for harvesting

NWFP name	Harvesting area(s) (name)	Parts harvested	Use purpose (traditional & others)	Harvesting season (month)	Estimated quantity that can be collected
<i>Aconitum laciniatum</i> (Dz. Bongkar)	Soeburi & Yulhagang	Root/ Tuber	Medicine	-	No collection to be done for now
<i>Aconitum orochryseum</i> (Dzo. Bong nga)	Soeburi & Yulhagang	Roots/ tuber	Medicine	-	No collection be done for now
<i>Rhododendron anthopogon</i> (Dz. Balu)	Soeburi & Yulhagang	Leaves and twigs	Incense	8 th & 9 th month of Bhutanese calendar	40 bags
<i>Rhododendron setosum</i> (Dz. Sulu)	Soeburi & Yulkhagang	Leaves and twigs	Incense	8 th & 9 th month of Bhutanese calendar	40 bags
Juniper leaves (Dzo. Shoopshing dhama)	Zasarpang, Gangkhangang, Thangkhangang, Eubja	Leaves	Incense	October & November (dry season)	1 T/L

Seuchu Shamoo	Gogochungsho, Thangkha, Tsherina, Tshelapang, Chubja	Whole parts of mushroom	Medicine	8 th & 12 th month of Bhutanese calendar	15 kg annually
<i>Borinda grossa</i> (Dzo. Baak)	Lamchuna, Tabina & Dakaysa	Culms	Basket making	2 nd & 10 th month of Bhutanese calendar	1 head load per HH annually
<i>Paris polyphylla</i> (Dzo. Dochu kewa)	Tsherina, Lamchuna, Dakaysa, Chimiching, Shongma, Tabina, Dhuksana, Jumjangsa, Tsheshila, Langchupang, Dho khatap, Taktalum and Tshochulum	Rhizomes	Medicine	October November	20 kg altogether by a group in a year

Collection guidelines

- From each household, only two collectors at a time shall be allowed to collect the NWFP
- The concern Gogona FMU Forest Ranger shall issue permits to the eligible collectors.
- The concern Gogona FMU Forest Ranger shall issue transit permit to the legitimate collectors during the time of transportation.
- The concern Gogona FMU Forest Ranger shall visit and inspect the collection areas to ensure that all garbage are collected by the collectors and properly disposed.

Table 2: Harvesting prescriptions for sustainable harvesting

NWFP species	Harvesting prescriptions for sustainable harvesting
<i>Paris polyphylla</i> (Dzo: Dochu kewa)	-Collection season is prescribed as October-November during which time its fruits get matured so that multiplication of its natural population is encouraged. -Only quantity prescribed shall be collected (20 kg altogether by the group) to avoid over harvesting. -If possible domestication trial shall be explored to enhance the production while controlling on collection from the wild or natural population.
Seuchu Shamoo	-Collection shall be twice in a year, especially day after the rain. -As this grows on the dead rosa shrub twigs, collection can be limitless as long as its growth is there. Because it being the mushroom (fungus) can be harvested before it gets perished to no use (waste).
<i>Rhododendron anthopogon</i> (Dz. Balu)	-use sharp knife or scissors to cut branches to collect leaves and twigs. -collect at the maximum 20% of the leaves and twigs from an individual shrub in order to avoid over harvesting. -collection shall be sole for sale within the members or collection shall be allowed only to cottage industry owned among members upon realization of fees.
<i>Rhododendron setosum</i> (Dz. Sulu)	-use sharp knife or scissors to cut branches to collect leaves and twigs. -collect at the maximum 20% of the leaves and twigs from an individual shrub in order to avoid over harvesting. - Collection shall be sole for sale within the members or collection shall be allowed only to cottage industry owned among members upon realization of fees.
Juniper leaves (Shoopshing)	-use sharp knife or scissors to cut branches to collect leaves and twigs. -collect at the maximum 20% of the leaves and twigs from an individual trees in order to avoid over harvesting and causing death to plant. Only young branchy plants shall be

	chosen for the harvesting. -Collection shall be sole for sale within the members or collection shall be allowed only to cottage industry owned among members upon realization of fees.
<i>Borinda grossa</i> (Dzo. Baak)	-Only the prescribed quantity shall be collected by the household members for domestic use. -No commercial harvesting shall be allowed as for now, if the population spreads over larger area, then group will decide the harvesting limit.
Other mushrooms (Dungshing shamoo, nagchu shamoo and sengye shamoo)	-These mushrooms shall be harvested only for domestic use for now. However, in future, once its abundance is ascertained, sales plan shall be added to the plan.

Table 3: Annual marketing and sales plan (forecast)

NWFP	Potential market	Estimated quantity for sale per season (unit)	Expected price per unit	Total (Nu)
<i>Paris polyphylla</i> (Dzo: Dochu kewa)	NITM and others	20 Kg	Nu. 7,000/-	Nu. 140,000.00
Seuchu Shamoo	Others	15 Kg	Nu. 5000/-	Nu. 75,000.00
<i>Rhododendron anthopogon</i> (Dz. Balu)	Drizhim Kuenchab Saangzay*	40 bags	Nu. 50/-	Nu. 2000.00
<i>Rhododendron setosum</i> (Dz. Sulu)	Drizhim Kuenchab Saangzay*	40 bags	Nu. 50/-	Nu. 2000.00
Juniper leaves (Dz. Shoopshing)	Drizhim Kuenchab Saangzay*	1 T/L	Nu. 3500/-	Nu. 3500.00

Note: * Drizhim Kuenchab Saangzay is an internal cottage industry, privately owned though is a member of the group. That's why the price is minimal which if the group collects and sold to the production industry. And group agreed these produce shall not be marketed at commercial scale.

Marketing arrangement

- All the NWFP group members shall have equal access to collect the NWFPs as per the Management Plan of the group.
- All NWFP collected shall be sold through auction for which the time and venue shall be fixed by the competent authorities (Either Gogona FMU Office or Gewog Administration).
- Sale of NWFP outside of the designated auction period and site shall be considered as an offence.
- From every member, 10% of the NWFP sale procured shall be contributed to the group fund.
- The fund generated from NWFP shall be given first priority in the development of NWFP group. The fund shall be utilized in the following activities:
 - Meet the expenses of the committee members for NWFP development services.
 - To meet expenses on hosting the guests

- Development activities within the village.

Monitoring and patrolling

- a) The concern Forest Ranger, or any Forest Personnel authorized by competent authority shall carry out monitoring of collection/harvesting of NWFP yearly.
- b) The monitoring teams shall develop the monitoring protocol for NWFP and assess before and after collection season.
- c) Monitoring report shall be presented during the time of NWFP general meeting and further submit to CFO

Part II: By-laws: Group Regulation and Norms

Villages	Eubja, Chubja, Thankha, Gogochungsho, Gogojab, Zasar, Gogona
Number of household	40 households
Name of the group	Gorgoen Shingmin Thoenketh Management Group
Gewog	Gangtey Gewog
Dzongkhag	Wangdue

Membership of the NWFP collection group

- Any person belonging to Gogona community holding House number (Gung), Thram number and census registered at Gogona chiwog shall have opportunity to become the member of Gorgoen Shingmin Thoenketh Management Group. Currently the group has 19 households as NWFP-user group members.
- If any People from Gogona chiwog wish to join as a new member of NWFP group, he /she shall be allowed after obtaining approval from the NWFP chairman and the NWFP committee. However, he /she has to pay work expenditures borne by an earlier individual member as a compensatory money to the group so that he or she can be treated at par with the old ones in entitlements.
- If any of the member wishes to withdraw from the group he/she will be allowed, but no compensation shall be paid for the outgoing members.

Roles and Responsibilities of the Group

- All the members of Gogona NWFP-user group have equal rights over the utilization of the resources (NWFP). Therefore, all have to bear equal responsibility to protect the resources.
- The group members shall work for the benefit of NWFP group rather than the individual benefit alone.
- The committee member shall not misuse the group funds for their own individual benefits.

- d) All the group members have to follow marketing procedure to sell the collected NWFP which is only through an auction. Individual/isolated sale of the collected products shall not be allowed.
- e) All group members shall attend meeting compulsorily and with enthusiasm whenever required.
- f) The group members shall work with full co-operation and shall contribute equal works while required to carry out for the benefit of NWFP group.
- g) The group shall manage the NWFP resources on a sustainable management system and follow the harvesting guideline which is signed in the NWFP agreement.
- h) The group shall protect/stop outsiders from collecting resources within the Group's designated area (specified in NWFP agreement).

Roles and Responsibilities of the Chairman

- a) He/she shall fix the date for general meeting, prepare agenda and facilitate the meeting.
- b) He/she shall coordinate the auctioning of the products in collaboration with Gogona FMU Management and Gewog Administration.
- c) He/she shall lead to prepare annual plans for NWFP's within signed NWFP agreement.
- d) He/she shall counter-sign on forms for the withdrawal of fund from group joint account maintained with the bank.
- e) He/she shall share official information and planning with NWFP group members.
- f) He/she shall explore fund/budget utilization for capacity building of the group on technical aspects.
- g) He/she shall be responsible of resolving conflicts that may arise within the group or with outsiders.
- h) He/she shall initiate review of the by-laws with support from NWFP members and Gogona FMU.

Roles and Responsibilities of Secretary

- a) He/she shall facilitate/chair the meetings in the absence of the Chairman.
- b) He/she shall provide assistance to the Chairman.
- c) He/she shall maintain records and keep minutes of the meeting.

- d) He/she shall counter-sign the Cheque with the Chairman and treasurer if the group need to withdrawal fund from the bank.
- e) He/she shall be responsible of checking the quality of the produces before the auction.
- f) He/she shall write official correspondences.
- g) He/she shall be responsible of disseminating information to group on latest market information (trends).

Roles and Responsibilities of treasurer

- a) He/she shall maintain all cash transaction records as well as official corresponding.
- b) He/she shall submit expenditure and cash balance reports to the Coordinator and present it to the group in meetings.
- c) He/she shall be responsible of collection of annual membership fees from the group members and deposit to group joint account.
- d) He/she shall be responsible of depositing and withdrawing of cash from the group joint account with the bank.
- e) He/she shall maintain records of produces collected and marketed by the group.
- f) He/she shall participate in the auction or sale of produces.
- g) He/she shall deduct Nu. 10% each from the sale of NWFP and deposit in group account.

Fund management

The Gorgoen Shingmin Thoenketh Management Group shall raise funds through.

- a) The group agreed to contribute Nu. 50/ each as a membership fee on annual basis.
- b) Nu. 110/- (Nu. 10/- permit fee and Nu. 100/- royalty for produce) shall be levied per occasion of issuance of produce (not specified here) collection permits.
- c) The fees shall be collected by treasurer from the chairman/secretary and deposited to the group joint account.
- d) The group has agreed to contribute 10% of the sale amount from each individual to the group fund.
- e) Fine and penalties collected from the group members as well as from the outsider shall go to the group account.

Conflict Management

- a) If there is any Conflict or disputes within the NWFP group members, the case shall be solved by Chairmen and committee. If incase Chairmen and committee couldn't solved the problem the case shall be forwarded to the Gewog Administration and Gogona FMU range Office.
- b) In case of disputes or conflicts among communities the case shall be resolved by Gogona FMU Range Officer.
- c) In case if the conflict is between the NWFP group and outsiders (non-residents), the case shall be forwarded to Gewog Administration and Gogona FMU Range Office.

Responsibilities of different agencies

Department of Forest and Gogona FMU Services (DoFPS) shall:

- a) Review and propose revised royalty rates through MoAF to the MoF as and when necessary
- b) Prepare and approve a list of NWFPs that can be traded according to the prescribed harvesting guidelines and shall make this list available to all relevant stakeholders (DAMC, BAFRA etc.)
- c) Disseminate information on available NWFPs in the country through a webpage
- d) Conduct research on NWFPs, especially on domestication, propagation, resource assessment, product development and the ecology of NWFP species based on request from stakeholders Coordinate between stakeholders involved in NWFP management and marketing
- e) Support PM in preparing NWFP Management & Marketing plans, NWFP resource assessments and field surveys upon request
- f) Develop strategies, management and harvesting guidelines and frameworks
- g) Develop a list of prioritized species which can be harvested by community groups according to the prescribed harvesting guidelines (Appendix 1). This list of prioritized species is dynamic wherein new species can be added or removed.
- h) Review prescriptions proposed by Gogona FMU and/or other agencies for NWFPs that are not yet included in Appendix 2.
- i) Develop and add harvesting guidelines for NWFPs not yet included in Appendix 2 as and when needed and if feasible.

- j) DoFPS reserves the right to revoke the NWFP management & marketing plan if the group is not functioning according to the plan prescriptions

Gogona FMU Ranger shall

- a) Identify marketing opportunities and potential NWFP harvesting areas in collaboration with local communities.
- b) In collaboration with local communities, assess availability of NWFP resources within proposed harvesting areas.
- c) Inform the NWFP management & marketing groups about market demands for NWFP commodities including price, quantity and quality requirements and facilitate the establishment of linkages with traders in collaboration with DAMC.
- d) Submit and review the NWFP plan whenever necessary.
- e) Gogona FMU Ranger shall issue NWFP harvesting permits as per FNCR (Appendix 3.1, 3.2)
- f) Make the required number of copies of the approved NWFP plan and shall distribute them to Gup, Gogona FMU Rangers, CFO, SFED and other relevant stakeholders. The original plan shall remain with the group.
- g) Support NWFP groups in the renewal of their NWFP management and marketing plans on completion of the time period.
- h) Coordinate and support NWFP groups in supply of materials and organization of trainings to strengthen NWFP production, management, processing, marketing, etc. based on request from the field and proper planning.
- i) Gogona FMU Ranger shall compile an annual progress report about NWFPs harvested and marketed by the NWFP management & marketing groups and shall send it to SFED, CFO and DAMC (see Appendix 4).
- j) PM shall review and approve the NWFP management & marketing plan submitted by the user group.
- k) Gogona FMU Rangers shall issue transit permit as per FNCRR (Appendix 3.3)
- l) Gogona FMU Ranger shall issue movement order for export as per FNCRR (Appendix 3.4)
- m) Gogona FMU Ranger shall be responsible for site verification and monitoring and evaluation of trends in availability of NWFP species in the field on a regular basis

- n) Gogona FMU Ranger shall collect the royalty from groups/ traders/ buyers/ or exporters (based on the prevailing Royalty Rates) and issues revenue receipt.

Department of Agricultural Marketing and Cooperatives (DAMC) shall

- a) Be responsible for obtaining up to date market information from buyers/ traders/ exporters and through independent market surveys and provide information to SFD/ DoFPS.
- b) Create a webpage with information on NWFP marketing and prices.
- c) Seek interested traders/ buyers / exporters to market NWFPs
- d) Be responsible for providing information on minimum quantity and quality requirements of NWFP commodities to SFED/DoFPS
- e) Promote and facilitate the purchase of NWFP produce by traders/ buyers/ exporters from NWFP groups and organize buyer-seller meetings.
- f) Provide capacity building on marketing aspects and group governance based on requests from the field and proper planning.
- g) Facilitate the marketing of NWFP commodities and provide a contract template specifying the terms & conditions for NWFP sales between NWFP groups and buyers
- h) Provide information on procedures for trade/ export of NWFPs based on requests.

Bhutan Agriculture & Food Regulatory Authority (BAFRA)

- a) BAFRA shall be responsible for monitoring, quality assurance and certification of NWFP produce for export.
- b) BAFRA shall support the development of standards for priority NWFP produce.
- c) Issuing clearance certificate for the exporter if required

NWFP Buyer and Exporters

Traders/ buyers/ exporters who buy from the NWFP management & marketing groups shall:

- a) Buy the NWFP commodities from the groups as per the mutually agreed price.
- b) Agree with the NWFP group on the date and venue to purchase the NWFPs.
- c) Obtain a transit permit (Appendix 3.3) from the Gogona FMU Range office.
- d) Obtain a movement order for export (Appendix 3.4) from the Gogona FMU Range Office
- e) Pay tax as per the requirement of the Department of Revenue and Custom
- f) Obtain clearance certificate from BAFRA if required